- **Context**—attributes like time of day, location, device security posture, or risk score are not natively supported in OpenFGA. The system only evaluates relationships. If you need to consider contextual information, it must be handled externally (in application logic or middleware), with the outcome encoded as a relationship (for example, “Alice has on-call access to prod”) or used to determine whether an OpenFGA check should be performed.

Taken together, OpenFGA’s approach to PARC emphasizes structure and scalability over flexibility. It performs best when access decisions can be fully expressed by a well-designed schema and a set of relationships that mirror the current state of the organization.

At ACME, this enabled engineers to create dynamic, delegatable access patterns within the Customer Collaboration platform without needing constant policy updates. However, it also meant that any logic related to external factors—such as time-based access or security posture—had to be managed outside the system. For teams whose access rules are based on human relationships rather than transient conditions, OpenFGA provides a clear and efficient foundation.